



# MIAO

AN ANCIENT CHINESE CULTURE

WITH A POPULATION OF OVER SEVEN MILLION, the Miao

people form one of the largest ethnic minorities in southwest China. They also have one of the world's most ancient cultures and can trace their

## The Long-Horned Miao

One clan of the group are the Long-Horned Miao, who are famous for their unique costumes and horned headpieces. They are from a village called Longga in southwest China, and it is only since the highway to the village was built in 1994 that these amazing people and their culture have been revealed to the world.

Houses on the hillsides are often built on stilts with the animals living beneath them.

### FABRIC DESIGN

The Miao people specialize in batik and embroidered fabrics, which are evident in their everyday dress. A girl learns to work with fabrics from the age of six or seven, and her skills greatly increase her value as a wife.



### HORN HEADPIECES

The women wear extraordinary headpieces that consist of hair wrapped around animal horns protruding from each side of their head. To keep the horns in place they wrap their own hair and an elongated bun made from linen, wool, and hair from ancient ancestors around them, and fix it all with white cord. The headpiece can be up to 10 ft (3 m) long and weigh up to 4 $\frac{1}{2}$  lb (2 kg).

